

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Plea Agreement with Appeal Waiver and Express Allocution Carve-Out

**United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v.
Mateo Serrano** Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Docket Entry 22 Filed
November 18, 2025

Mateo Serrano and the fictional United States enter this written agreement concerning Count One of the indictment. Serrano agrees to plead guilty to conspiracy to commit wire fraud, in violation of 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343. The charge concerns an abstract scheme involving false reimbursement claims for services not performed against the fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative between August 4 and November 2, 2025.

This agreement is synthetic. It omits any account data, credentials, routing information, transmission method, evasion practice, or other operational detail. The parties use the agreement to preserve issues about waiver, sentencing procedure, and an aggravating-role recommendation. They do not offer it as guidance about committing or investigating an offense.

Serrano confirms that he has reviewed each page with defense counsel Celia Arden, has had his questions answered, and enters the agreement voluntarily. Government counsel Bram Ives confirms that the written terms state the complete agreement. Acceptance remains for the court after the personal inquiry required by Rule 11.

Charge and Elements

Count One alleges that Serrano knowingly joined an agreement to use interstate wire communications in furtherance of a scheme to obtain money through materially false reimbursement claims. To establish guilt, the government would have to prove beyond a reasonable doubt that the charged agreement existed, that Serrano knowingly and voluntarily joined it, and that a member intended the underlying wire-fraud object. Serrano understands that mere association or innocent work would not suffice.

For this plea only, Serrano admits that he knowingly participated in the charged agreement and that the conduct continued through November 2, 2025. The stipulated factual basis filed separately describes the admitted facts without disclosing operational mechanics. Serrano does not admit every characterization in a future presentence report, and he retains the right to object to a sentencing recommendation not expressly resolved here.

The maximum penalties and other consequences will be explained by the court. Serrano understands that the court is not bound by counsel's estimate of the advisory range and may consider lawful information at sentencing. The plea is to Count One as charged; no separate count is dismissed as consideration for this agreement.

Fictional Participants and Reserved Role Dispute

The parties agree that the criminal activity involved exactly five criminally responsible participants: Mateo Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt. The names and conduct are entirely fictional. Serrano admits his own knowing participation and does not dispute the numerical five-participant predicate for purposes of the advisory Guidelines.

The parties do not agree that Serrano managed or supervised another participant. The government expects to argue that communications with Alina Pared reflected supervision of a person. Serrano expects to argue that the interactions reflected coordination among equals. No term of this agreement resolves that factual dispute, and no stipulation rests on management of property, assets, or activities alone.

The probation office may evaluate U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b) under the 2025 Guidelines Manual. The parties may submit objections and evidence in the manner permitted by the sentencing rules. Serrano's guilty plea does not waive his right to contest the adjustment in the district court. The separate appellate waiver below governs whether a resulting sentencing claim may later be presented on appeal.

Guidelines Manual and Advisory Calculation

The parties agree that the offense was completed on November 2, 2025, after the effective date of the 2025 Guidelines Manual. They therefore anticipate use of that Manual under U.S.S.G. § 1B1.11, subject to the court's independent determination and any constitutional limitation. Neither party identifies a whole-manual comparison that would require an earlier edition.

The current estimate assumes criminal-history category I. If the court applies the disputed three-level manager-or-supervisor adjustment, the parties presently estimate a total offense level of 20 and an advisory imprisonment range of 33 to 41 months. Without that adjustment, the corresponding estimate is level 17 and 24 to 30 months. These figures are not promises and may change if the presentence investigation identifies a lawful correction.

The court alone determines the advisory range and the sentence. A mistaken estimate by counsel does not permit withdrawal of the plea. At the same time, Serrano may place a timely objection on the sentencing record. This agreement separates that district-court objection from the appeal rights that Serrano knowingly surrenders, preserving the text needed for a focused Rule 11 inquiry.

Restitution and Financial Terms

Serrano agrees that the fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative sustained an aggregate loss of \$186,400 attributable to the charged conspiracy. He agrees that the court may order restitution in that amount, subject to lawful allocation and credit for payments by any jointly responsible person. The figure is a synthetic exercise value and identifies no real victim or transaction.

Serrano also understands that a mandatory special assessment of \$100 applies to Count One. The government presently does not request a punitive fine, but the court retains the authority provided by law. Any restitution schedule will be determined at sentencing after consideration of the available record. No payment instruction, account number, or collection credential appears in this agreement.

The parties make no promise concerning forfeiture because no forfeiture count or agreed money judgment is included here. The court may impose lawful conditions of supervised release and may consider restitution obligations when setting a payment schedule. Serrano's acceptance of the stipulated amount does not resolve the distinct aggravating-role dispute and does not authorize either party to use financial mechanics as a substitute for proof that he managed or supervised another person.

Government Obligations

The government agrees to accept Serrano's plea to Count One and to credit his timely acceptance of responsibility if his conduct remains consistent with that position. It will disclose material sentencing information as required and will not argue that this agreement itself establishes the disputed aggravating-role adjustment. The government may, however, present its position that Serrano supervised Alina Pared and may respond to the defense objection.

Ives will accurately describe the agreement at the Rule 11 hearing and will not claim that Serrano surrendered the express allocution exception stated below. The government will honor every promise in this writing. No promise has been made about a particular sentence, placement, release date, or result on the role objection.

If Serrano provides materially false information, obstructs the proceeding, or otherwise acts inconsistently with acceptance of responsibility, the government may advise the court of that conduct. Ordinary good-faith litigation of the role adjustment does not constitute a breach by Serrano. Likewise, the government's good-faith advocacy for the adjustment does not constitute a breach of the agreement. Any alleged breach will be evaluated from this integrated writing and the Rule 11 record.

Rights Relinquished by the Plea

By pleading guilty, Serrano gives up the right to persist in a plea of not guilty, to a speedy and public jury trial, to require the government to prove guilt beyond a reasonable doubt, to confront and cross-examine witnesses, to compel witnesses, and to remain silent without an adverse inference. He understands that a guilty plea permits entry of a judgment of conviction without a trial.

Serrano retains the right to counsel at every critical stage, the right to review the presentence materials available to him and Arden, the right to object under Rule 32, and the right to be personally heard before sentence. The appeal waiver on the next pages separately addresses review after judgment. No provision converts counsel's speech into Serrano's personal allocution.

Serrano confirms that he has discussed possible defenses with Arden and is satisfied with her representation. He is not pleading because of force, threat, or an undisclosed promise. He understands the English-language text used here, and no interpreter has been requested. The court will verify these matters through personal questions before deciding whether to accept the plea.

Appeal Waiver

Serrano knowingly and expressly waives the right to appeal the conviction and whatever sentence is imposed on any ground, including any appeal under 18 U.S.C. § 3742, except that the waiver does not bar a claim that the sentencing court completely denied him the personal opportunity to allocute required by Rule 32(i)(4)(A)(ii).

The waiver includes an ordinary claim that the court miscalculated the advisory Guidelines, including a challenge to application of U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b). It applies even though Serrano may preserve that objection in the district court and even if the court adopts the government's position. The parties intend the role-enhancement target to fall within the broad waiver.

The stated exception is narrow and express. It concerns a complete denial of Serrano's personal opportunity to speak before sentence. It does not reserve every disagreement about the length, timing, or subject of allocution, and it does not reserve a Guidelines challenge merely because sentencing procedure is also disputed. The court will explain both the surrendered rights and the exception personally to Serrano before accepting the plea.

Allocution Carve-Out and Severability

The parties agree that the allocution sentence is part of the bargained waiver, not a recital or prediction. If a later claim falls within that express exception, the government will not argue that the broad sentencing-waiver language silently removes it. If a claim falls outside the exception, the ordinary waiver remains available according to its terms.

The exception does not state that a denial will occur. The sentencing court remains expected to comply fully with Rule 32(i)(4)(A)(ii) by addressing Serrano personally and allowing him to speak or present information in mitigation. The agreement creates no script for that exchange and does not limit Serrano's lawful opportunity to speak.

The waiver provisions are severable by claim and target. A conclusion that the reserved allocution claim may be heard does not open a waived role-enhancement challenge. Conversely, enforcement of the waiver against a Guidelines issue does not predetermine whether the sentencing court supplied a personal invitation to allocute or whether a preserved error affected substantial rights. This target-specific structure is material to the parties' agreement and will be tested in the Rule 11 colloquy.

Presentence Process and Confidentiality

If the court accepts the plea, the probation office will prepare a presentence report under Rule 32 and the applicable local rules. Serrano and counsel may review the report through authorized channels, submit objections, and respond to revisions. A report, response, or objection will remain subject to the confidentiality and sealing rules that govern presentence material. This agreement does not make a future report public.

The parties expect the report to address the offense, the five-participant predicate, the disputed person-management question, the advisory calculation, criminal history, restitution, and mitigation. That expectation does not direct the probation officer's findings. Personal history and other nonpublic details should not be copied into public filings merely because a sentencing position refers to them.

Nothing here represents access to a real probation system, CM/ECF account, or court record. Any later public surrogate in this synthetic corpus will describe categories and filing status only; it will not be a redacted presentence report. Counsel shall serve confidential sentencing materials by the means allowed at the time and shall protect them from unnecessary copying or dissemination.

Breach, Withdrawal, and Entire Agreement

If the court rejects this agreement or declines to accept the plea, the parties retain the rights provided by Rule 11. Serrano may not withdraw an accepted plea merely because the sentence or advisory range differs from an estimate. Any later motion to withdraw must satisfy the governing rule and is not authorized in advance by this paragraph.

This writing, together with the stipulated factual basis solely for the facts it contains, is the entire plea agreement. No officer, attorney, or agent has promised immunity, a particular sentence, a recommendation not stated here, or a result on appeal. Amendments must be written, signed by Serrano, Arden, and Ives, and accepted in a manner the court finds appropriate.

A material breach by either side may permit a remedy recognized by law. A good-faith role objection, a government response supporting the adjustment, or a preserved claim within the allocution exception is not a breach. Serrano confirms that Arden has explained the consequences of breach and the difference between district-court sentencing advocacy and the appellate waiver. The government confirms that it will not broaden the waiver beyond the words accepted by the court.

Acknowledgments and Signatures

Serrano states that he is entering this agreement freely, understands the charge and maximum consequences described at the hearing, and has read or had read to him every provision. He specifically acknowledges the estimated ranges, the unresolved § 3B1.1(b) issue, the \$186,400 restitution stipulation, and the absence of any guaranteed sentence.

Serrano further acknowledges that the appeal waiver broadly covers conviction and sentencing claims, including the disputed Guidelines enhancement, while expressly preserving only a claim that the court completely denied him the personal opportunity to allocute required by Rule 32(i)(4)(A)(ii). Arden certifies that she has separately discussed the waiver and exception with him. Ives certifies that the government accepts the same target-specific meaning and has made no inconsistent promise.

The parties request that the court conduct the personal colloquy and, if satisfied, accept Serrano's plea. Their signatures do not substitute for the court's findings. This synthetic agreement bears fictional names and identifiers and concerns no real defendant, victim, prosecution office, or criminal event.

Mateo Serrano Fictional Defendant

Celia Arden Fictional Defense Counsel

Bram Ives Fictional Government Counsel